Yu Qiu

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Placement director:	Dr. Andreas Ferrara	+1 (412) 499-0819	a.ferrara@pitt.edu
Placement officer:	Mr. Dane Youkers	+1 (412) 624-6094	dcy14@pitt.edu

Department of Economics
University of Pittsburgh
4700 Wesley W. Posvar Hall
Pittsburgh, PA 15260

Email: YUQ23@pitt.edu
Web: jessyuqiu.github.io
Phone: +1 (412) 209-5610

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, University of Pittsburgh, 2021-2027 (expected)
Committee: Andreas Ferrara (Co-chair), Daniel Berkowitz (Co-chair), Muhammad Yasir Khan, Osea Giuntella, and Vasiliki Fouka

M.A. Economics, University of Pittsburgh, 2023

B.A. Economics & B.S. Mathematics (*with distinction*), Wuhan University, 2021

RESEARCH FIELD

Labor Economics, Political Economy, Economic History, Development Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Fathers in Office, Sons in Jobs: Intergenerational Returns to Local Political Office"

Abstract: How does entry into local political office affect the long-run labor-market outcomes of officeholders' children, and what role do merit-based civil service institutions play? To study these questions, I construct a new dataset by digitizing rosters of township, village, and city officials in early twentieth-century Ohio and linking them to full-count U.S. censuses. This allows me to trace their adult children's labor-market outcomes from 1900 to 1940. Using a matched difference-in-differences design, I find that fathers' entry into office increases sons' occupational income score and white-collar employment, with gains persisting for decades after fathers leave office. In 1940, officials' sons earn about 13% more in annual wage income than their matched counterparts, while effects on daughters are more limited in this period of low female labor force participation. These gains are driven by increased access to both public-sector employment and private-sector white-collar jobs. Public-sector gains are particularly larger where local officials have greater hiring discretion and for sons with lower pre-office occupational standing. Exploiting the staggered adoption of municipal civil service reforms across cities, I find that civil service reforms do not eliminate the intergenerational political advantages. Instead, sons' private-sector white-collar gains become significantly larger when fathers enter office after the reform.

WORKING PAPERS

1. "Building Jobs: Employment Stabilization and Construction in China"

2. "Migrant Integration and Social Stability: Evidence from China", with Weizheng Lai
3. "Geopolitical Tensions and Economic Opportunity: Evidence from Japan", with Weizheng Lai

PUBLICATION

1. "Are More Children Better than One? Evidence from a Lab Experiment of Decision Making", with Xun Li, *China Economic Review*, Vol. 69, October 2021

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. "Bureaucratic Quality and Local Industrial Development", with Muhammad Yasir Khan and S. K. Ritadhi
2. "Representation and Resource Allocation Before and After the 17th Amendment", with Noah Braun, Paige Montrose, and Lauren Olson

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Intro Microeconomic Theory 2024, 2025

Teaching Assistant, Health Economics 2024, 2026

Teaching Assistant, Intro Microeconomic Theory 2023

Teaching Assistant, Intro Development Economics 2022

Teaching Assistant, Ph.D. Introduction to Mathematical Methods 2022

SEMINAR AND WORKSHOP PRESENTATION

2026: Applied Young Economists' Webinar (AYEW), AMIE Workshop, BEDI Labor and Development Conference, Cliometrics Conference, EUI PEARL Workshop, EALE Conference, EHA Conference, NEUDC Conference

2025: Labor and Development Brownbag, Applied Microeconomics Brownbag (University of Pittsburgh)

2024: SEA Meeting, UEA NA Meeting, 23rd CEPR Summer School in International and Development Economics, CES NA Annual Conference, Labor and Development Brownbag, Applied Microeconomics Brownbag (University of Pittsburgh)

2023: Labor and Development Brownbag, Applied Microeconomics Brownbag (University of Pittsburgh)

2020: The 12th International Symposium on Human Capital and Labor Markets

AWARDS AND GRANTS

PBC Travel Grants, University of Pittsburgh (2024, 2026)

Mellon Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh (2024-2025)

Best Second-year Paper Award (2024)

Chou Predoctoral Fellowship for Economics, University of Pittsburgh (2021-2022, 2025-2026)

Arts and Sciences Summer Fellowships, 2023

China National Scholarship (2020)

First Class Scholarship, Wuhan University (2019, 2020)

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES AND MEMBERSHIP

Journal referee for: *China Economic Review, The Journal of the Economics of Ageing*

Member of: Economic History Association, Cliometric Society, European Association of Labor Economists, American Economic Association

Graduate Student Peer Mentor, University of Pittsburgh, 2022-2024

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Software: Stata, Matlab, Python

Language: Mandarin Chinese, English, Spanish (basic)

REFERENCES

Prof. Andreas Ferrara
Department of Economics
University of Pittsburgh
a.ferrara@pitt.edu

Prof. Daniel Berkowitz
Department of Economics
University of Pittsburgh
dmberk@pitt.edu

Prof. Yasir Khan
Department of Economics
University of Pittsburgh
myk17@pitt.edu

Prof. Osea Giuntella
Department of Economics
University of Pittsburgh
osea.giuntella@pitt.edu